

SCHOOL COUNSELING SERVICES – ELEMENTARY, MIDDLE, AND HIGH SCHOOL

Each school shall establish a data driven process for determining the specific counseling needs of students and for planning how to effectively meet those needs. School counseling shall be provided for all students, as needed, and shall be designed to achieve the following goals based on the Standards for School Counseling Programs in Virginia public Schools.

A. Program Goals

1. Ensure that individual on-going academic and career planning is provided at the elementary and secondary levels to assist each student in establishing personal goals and developing future plans.
2. Provide opportunities for parents/guardians and teachers to participate in planned activities that encourage the personal, social, educational, and career development of students.
3. Provide a curriculum that consists of structured classroom or group lessons designed to help students attain the desired educational competencies and to provide all students with the knowledge, outlooks and skills appropriate for their developmental level in collaboration with other educators.
4. Provide an annual evaluation of the comprehensive school counseling program to an advisory council including the principal, counselor(s), staff, parents or legal guardians and/or other stakeholders.
5. Ensure that at least 60% of the school counselor's time shall be devoted to direct and indirect services with students.
6. Ensure that each secondary student meets annually with their school counselor to plan a schedule and develop a planned program of studies that contributes to meeting graduation requirements.

B. Description of Service

1. School counseling programs support the Standards of Learning by providing guidance to students in their academic, career and personal and social development. School counselors collaborate and communicate with parents, teachers, administrators, psychologists, social workers and others to promote learning, address social-emotional needs and help students establish and achieve their educational goals.
2. **Academic Development** – Students will acquire the academic preparation essential to choose from a variety of educational, training, and employment options upon completion of secondary school.

SCHOOL COUNSELING SERVICES –
ELEMENTARY, MIDDLE, AND HIGH SCHOOL

3. **Career Development** – Students will investigate the world of work to make informed career decisions.

4. **Social/Emotional** – Students will acquire an understanding of, and respect for, self and others, and the skills to be responsible citizens.

C. Notification and Student Participation

1. The School Division shall provide annual written notification to parents/legal guardians and adult students about the academic, career, and personal/social counseling programs which are available. The notification shall include the purpose and general description of the program, information regarding ways parents may review materials to be used in guidance and counseling programs at the student's school, and information about the procedures by which parents/legal guardians and adult students may limit participation in such programs.

2. The local school shall also provide written notification of an overview of the school program, including a brief description of the school counseling services and the counseling services that may be offered during the school year.

3. School counseling materials shall be made available at each school for review by any interested person by contacting the school counselor.

- a. No student shall be required to participate in any school counseling program to which the minor student's parents/legal guardians or the adult student object. However, parental consent shall not be required for short duration counseling needed to maintain order and discipline, or for those situations which may require the immediate attention of the counselor.
- b. Minor student's parents/guardians or adult students have the option to withdraw from all or any portion of the school counseling program by directing their opt-out request in writing to the school principal.
- c. Written parental consent of minor students or adult student consent will be required before students participate in a planned program of group counseling or individual counseling that is conducted on a continuing basis.

SCHOOL COUNSELING SERVICES –
ELEMENTARY, MIDDLE, AND HIGH SCHOOL

4. The use of counseling techniques which are beyond the scope of the professional certification or training of school counselors, including hypnosis or other psychotherapeutic techniques that are normally employed in medical or clinical settings and focus on the mental illness or psychopathology, is strictly prohibited.

5. Information and records of social-emotional counseling shall be kept confidential and separate from a student's educational records and not disclosed to third parties without prior parental/guardian consent of the minor student or adult student; or as otherwise provided by law.

[Former Regulation 5-6]
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Leg Refs: [8VAC20-620-10](#). School guidance and counseling services.

Code of Virginia [22.1-253.13:1](#). Standard 1. Instructional programs supporting the Standards of Learning and other educational objectives.

Standards for School Counseling Programs in Virginia Public Schools, 2004